

F5 Daily Briefing – Thursday, July 23, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

19

ANNOUNCEMENTS

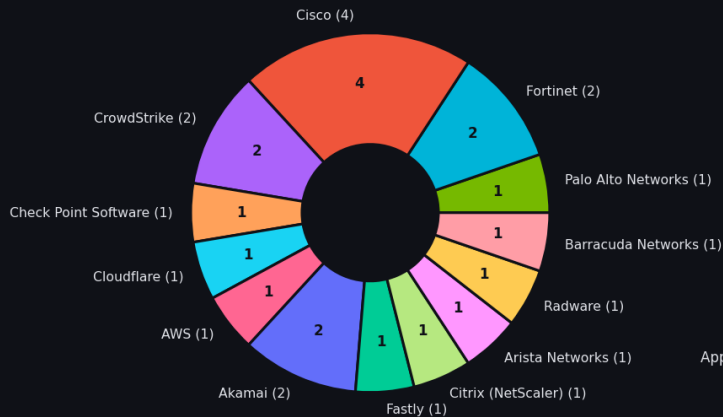
13

ACTIVE

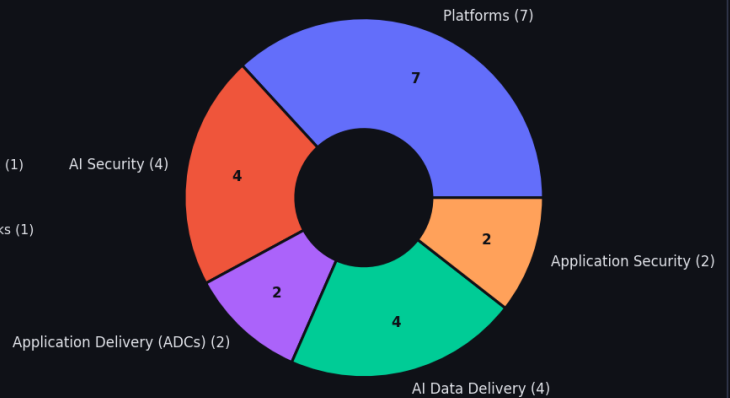
5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

PARTNERSHIP

Fastly

2026-07-24

Fastly Joins Experian Agent Trust Ecosystem to Advance Trusted AI Commerce

Fastly joined Experian's Agent Trust ecosystem to help verify AI agents, authorize transactions, and make real-time trust decisions in autonomous commerce. The integration extends Fastly's edge cloud to the trust framework, enabling identity verification, delegated authority, and transaction confidence at the edge without rewriting existing APIs, authentication, payment workflows, or security controls. The collaboration aims to let trusted AI commerce scale with near-instantaneous, millisecond authorization while preserving customer experience.

<https://ca.finance.yahoo.com/news/fastly-joins-experian-agent-trust-130000956.html>

ACQUISITION

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-23

Palo Alto Networks to Acquire Embrace, Launches Synthetics to Expand Observability Platform

Palo Alto Networks announced it will acquire real-user monitoring (RUM) provider Embrace to extend its Observability Platform into Digital Experience Monitoring. Alongside the deal, it launched Synthetics, developed by its ADEM team, to proactively validate application performance from distributed locations. Both capabilities will connect with Cortex AgentiX for automated issue detection and remediation. The Embrace acquisition, which follows January's Chronosphere deal, is expected to close in fiscal Q1 2027.

<https://www.itpro.com/business/acquisition/palo-alto-networks-targets-application-observability-gains-with-latest-acquisition>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-07-23

Fortinet and Intel Collaborate on Next-Gen SP6 Security Processor

Fortinet expanded its partnership with Intel to co-develop the next-generation Fortinet Security Processor 6 (SP6), with Intel fabricating the chip on its Intel 4 node as its first named external foundry customer. The collaboration combines Fortinet's purpose-built security-ASIC expertise with Intel's design, packaging, and manufacturing capabilities to accelerate development and diversify Fortinet's supply chain away from Taiwan/Japan concentration. Fortinet shares jumped over 8% on the news.

<https://mlq.ai/news/fortinet-taps-intel-4-for-sp6-security-chip-giving-intel-foundry-a-concrete-customer-win/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Fortinet**

2026-07-23

Fortinet Upgrades FortiEndpoint to Secure Enterprise AI Adoption

Fortinet updated its FortiEndpoint platform with new capabilities to secure AI adoption and combat shadow AI. Enhancements include central visibility and policy control over approved versus unapproved AI tools, built-in data loss prevention that inspects information shared with AI tools, and risk-based adaptive access tied to device health. FortiAI-Assist adds a natural-language interface for analysts to investigate events and identify high-risk devices, all unified within the Fortinet Security Fabric.

<https://context.ph/2026/07/23/fortinet-upgrades-fortiendpoint-platform-to-secure-ai-adoption-and-streamline-endpoint-security/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Cisco**

2026-07-23

Cisco Patches Actively Exploited Catalyst SD-WAN Vulnerability

Cisco warned that a vulnerability in its Catalyst SD-WAN components (Controller, Manager, Validator) has been exploited in the wild, in limited cases involving configuration changes pushed to edge devices. CVE-2026-20245 carries a CVSS score of 7.8, and Cisco PSIRT began receiving exploitation reports in June. Cisco released software updates and issued a Live Protect shield to provide temporary coverage while customers plan upgrades, noting no available workarounds.

<https://www.isssource.com/cisco-clears-sd-wan-vulnerability/>

PARTNERSHIP**Cisco**

2026-07-23

Tenable Joins Cisco's SolutionsPlus Program as Exposure Management Partner

Tenable joined Cisco's SolutionsPlus program, giving Cisco Vulnerability Management customers a path to migrate to unified exposure management with Tenable One. The offering delivers real-time visibility, context, and prioritization across the attack surface using native Tenable sensors, 330+ integrations, and Tenable Hexa AI for rapid action. The partnership includes a secure transition path plus Tenable Professional Services to accelerate deployment and strengthen preemptive defense in the AI era.

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/07/23/3332170/0/en/Tenable-Joins-Cisco-s-SolutionsPlus-Program-as-an-Exposure-Management-Partner-for-Vulnerability-Management-Customers.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-07-23

Cisco Launches Antares Open-Weight AI Models to Find Code Vulnerabilities

Cisco released Antares, a family of open-weight, security-focused small language models built to locate vulnerabilities in real-world source code. The initial Antares-350M and Antares-1B models (Apache 2.0, on Hugging Face) can be self-hosted to keep sensitive code on-premises, using vulnerability-centered prompts to iteratively inspect repositories and rank risky files with audit traces. In benchmarks, Antares-1B outperformed far larger models. Cisco also published a Vulnerability Localization Benchmark, tying the effort into its Foundry AI-for-defense framework.

<https://www.webpronews.com/ciscos-antares-models-challenge-ai-giants-in-hunt-for-software-flaws/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-07-23

Cisco Unveils Enterprise Local AI Architecture with AMD Ryzen AI Halo

Cisco announced an enterprise-ready local AI architecture built on AMD Ryzen AI Halo, combining on-device execution with cloud providers and a Semantic Router for cost optimization. Cisco Cloud Control provides unified policy, control, and visibility across devices and agents, while Splunk observability, AI Defense for model/agent security, and DefenseClaw for on-device guardrails deliver full-stack protection. The network can quarantine problematic agents and correlate device, employee, and agent identities across the fleet.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/ai/from-one-desk-to-the-whole-enterprise-making-local-ai-resilient>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-23

Cato Networks and CrowdStrike Partner to Unify Network and Endpoint Security

CrowdStrike and Cato Networks announced a joint integration unifying the Cato SASE Platform with the CrowdStrike Falcon platform. Cato XOps correlates with Falcon Discover to link endpoint detections with network telemetry, enrich asset visibility, and stream Cato network data into Falcon Next-Gen SIEM for broader threat hunting. The collaboration closes visibility gaps and speeds investigations through a single security-operations workflow, generally available worldwide via the CrowdStrike Marketplace.

<https://siliconangle.com/2026/07/23/cato-networks-crowdstrike-partner-unify-network-endpoint-security/>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-23

CrowdStrike and Cerebras Partner to Power Falcon AI Detection and Response

CrowdStrike partnered with Cerebras Systems to run Falcon AI Detection and Response (AIDR) models on Cerebras' CS-3 wafer-scale inference hardware, delivering real-time, AI-native security across data, models, agents, and identities. Cerebras named CrowdStrike its first security-specific fast-inference customer and will standardize on Falcon to protect its own operations. The deal underscores the importance of low-latency AI for preventing and understanding threats in AI-heavy environments.

<https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/crowdstrike-taps-cerebras-systems-ai-chips-for-cybersecurity-at-speed/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Check Point Software**

2026-07-23

Check Point Discloses Actively Exploited SmartConsole Zero-Day (CVE-2026-16232)

Check Point disclosed a critical authentication-bypass zero-day (CVE-2026-16232, CVSS 9.3) in its Security Management and Multi-Domain Management products, exploited in the wild via SmartConsole. Unauthenticated attackers could obtain an admin login token and gain full privileges to alter security policies. Check Point patched within 72 hours, notified affected customers, and released jumbo hotfixes for R81.20, R82, and R82.10. CISA added the flaw to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog with a July 25 federal remediation deadline.

<https://www.securityweek.com/new-check-point-zero-day-vulnerability-exploited-in-the-wild/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-07-23

Cloudflare Introduces Cache Response Rules

Cloudflare launched Cache Response Rules, a new rule type that runs after the origin responds but before content is cached. It lets customers fix caching issues caused by Set-Cookie, ETag, Last-Modified, or restrictive Cache-Control headers without changing origin code, rewriting directives, managing cache-tags, and stripping headers at the edge. When conflicts arise, response-phase rules take precedence over cache rules. The feature is available on all Cloudflare plans and exposed via Dashboard, Rulesets API, and Terraform.

<https://blog.cloudflare.com/introducing-cache-response-rules/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-23

AWS Turns Security Hub into an AI and Multicloud Security Control Plane

AWS expanded Security Hub into a unified security control plane spanning cloud and AI workloads, now extending to Microsoft Azure. New capabilities include Azure resource monitoring against CIS benchmarks, GuardDuty AI Protection for AI workloads, GuardDuty AI-powered investigations in preview, and a Security Hub AI inventory that maps Bedrock models and SageMaker endpoints to compute, networking, IAM, and data stores. AWS positions the release as a blueprint for consolidating security tooling in the AI era.

<https://siliconangle.com/2026/07/22/aws-turns-security-hub-ai-multicloud-security-control-plane/>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**Akamai**

2026-07-23

Akamai Warns PQC Migration Deadlines Demand a Coherent DNS Estate

Akamai highlighted that the U.S. executive order on post-quantum cryptography (EO 14412) sets hard migration deadlines—key establishment by end of 2030 and digital signatures by end of 2031—for federal entities and contractors. Akamai stressed that crypto-agility extends beyond algorithm choices to a cryptographically coherent DNS estate, and noted it already supports PQC on its CDN for quantum-safe traffic today. It urged organizations to inventory DNSSEC deployment and dependencies across multi-cloud DNS providers.

<https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/pqc-migration-deadline-dns-estate>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**Akamai**

2026-07-23

Akamai CEO Pitches Distributed Edge Infrastructure for AI Inference

Akamai CEO Tom Leighton argued that massive centralized data centers are not the optimal path for scaling AI, outlining Akamai's alternative of a distributed AI infrastructure built on its network of existing facilities. The approach targets low latency, high performance, and cost-effective compute for AI inference rather than concentrating power in hyperscale campuses. Backed by NVIDIA, Akamai aims to extend its internet-style edge architecture to AI, emphasizing inference over training in a federated, edge-centric model.

<https://www.fastcompany.com/91576638/akamais-ceo-thinks-bigger-data-centers-wont-solve-every-ai-problem>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Citrix (NetScaler)**

2026-07-23

Citrix Brings Unified LLM and Agentic AI Governance to NetScaler with MCP Gateway

Citrix announced NetScaler MCP Gateway capabilities, delivering unified governance for both LLM and Model Context Protocol (MCP) agent traffic from a single platform. New features add secure routing, authentication, and observability for backend MCP servers, plus policy-based model routing and token-level usage tracking for high-volume LLM traffic with per-team visibility. A single-pass architecture handles governance, security, rate limiting, and observability in one data path to minimize latency, included at no extra cost for platform-license customers.

<https://thesiliconreview.com/2026/07/citrix-netscaler-mcp-gateway-ai-llm-agentic-governance>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Arista Networks**

2026-07-23

Arista Introduces AI-Driven Zero Trust Edge Threat Management for VeloCloud SD-WAN

Arista Networks unveiled AI-driven Edge Threat Management (ETM) for VeloCloud SD-WAN, delivering integrated zero-trust security for enterprise branch offices via a software upgrade. ETM unifies security and SD-WAN on a single edge platform with advanced firewalling, threat prevention, zone-based segmentation, DNS/Geo-IP filtering, and AI-powered policy insights managed from the VeloCloud Orchestrator. Built on Arista AVA, tools like Policy Explainer and Traffic Simulation simplify complex policies. ETM will be generally available in Q4 2026 across current VeloCloud platforms.

<https://digitrendz.blog/tech-news/223630/arista-brings-ai-zero-trust-to-velocloud-sd-wan/>

RESEARCH REPORT**Radware**

2026-07-23

Radware 2026 Cyber Survey Highlights Urgent Need to Secure the AI Layer

Radware released its 2026 Cyber Survey on AI, API, and application security, conducted with Osterman Research. It found 83% of organizations use GenAI/LLMs and 96% plan AI agents within 12 months, yet only 17% have full visibility into AI-driven processes and just 14% into AI crawler traffic. API development is outpacing security, with 48% updating APIs daily but only 19% maintaining automated inventories. Application-layer DDoS attacks hit 71% monthly, with downtime averaging roughly \$451,800 per hour.

<https://ai-techpark.com/radware-survey-highlights-need-to-secure-ai-layer/>

BUSINESS UPDATE

Barracuda Networks

2026-07-23

Barracuda Advances Partner Success Program with New Offerings

Barracuda Networks announced enhancements to its Partner Success Program aimed at MSPs and channel partners. Updates include a redesigned partner experience with a through-channel marketing automation platform for co-branded campaigns and 'do-it-for-me' execution, a forthcoming Partner Locator, and integration with the AI-powered BarracudaONE cyber-resilience platform. The company also expanded its Mastery Program with deeper role-based learning, new technical labs, and advanced certification badges, plus guided partner journeys to accelerate time to value.

<https://smbtech.au/news/barracuda-expands-partner-program-with-new-demand-generation-tools-and-training-pathways/>